INDIA-BRAZIL-SOUTH AFRICA (IBSA) TRILATERAL

IBSA is a trilateral, developmental initiative between India, Brazil and South Africa to promote South-South cooperation and exchange. During the G-8 meeting that took place in Evian in 2003, the Heads of State and Government of the IBSA countries floated the idea of this trilateral initiative. This was followed up by trilateral consultations, and finally, the trilateral took concrete shape when the Foreign Ministers of the respective countries met in Brasilia on 6 June 2003. At this meeting between Ministers Nkosazana Dlamini Zuma from South Africa, Celso Amorim from Brazil and Yashwant Sinha from India, the launching of the IBSA Dialogue Forum was formalized through the adoption of the Brasilia Declaration.

The main objectives of the IBSA Dialogue Forum are as follows:

1. To promote South-South dialogue, cooperation and common positions on issues of international importance
2. To promote trade and investment opportunities between the three regions of which they form a part
3. To promote international poverty alleviation and social development
4. To promote the trilateral exchange of information, international best practices, technologies and skills, as well as to compliment each other's competitive strengths into collective synergie.
5. To promote cooperation in a broad range of areas, namely agriculture, climate change, culture, defence, education, energy, health, information society, science and technology, social development, trade and investment, tourism and transport.

The IBSA Dialogue Forum has regular consultations at Senior Official (Focal Point), Ministerial (Trilateral Joint Commission) and Heads of State and/or Government (Summit) levels, but also facilitates interaction amongst academics, business and other members of civil society. Table 20.3 shows the list of IBSA Summit.